

Activity: regression with multiple explanatory variables

Group members:

Sparrows

In this class activity, we will revisit the `Sparrows` dataset, which looks at measurements of sparrows from Kent Island. Researchers measured the weight and wing length of 116 sparrows, under three different nest conditions: control (the researchers didn't change the nest), enlarged (the researchers made the nest bigger), and reduced (the researchers made the nest smaller). The `Sparrows` data is part of the `Stat2Data` package, and contains the following variables:

- **Treatment:** nest condition (control, enlarged, or reduced)
- **Weight:** sparrow weight (in grams)
- **WingLength:** sparrow wing length (in mm)

Questions

1. Write down the population regression model, with weight as the response, and wing length and treatment as the predictors.

Here is the output of the fitted model in R:

Coefficients:

	Estimate	Std. Error	t value	Pr(> t)	
(Intercept)	1.94244	0.91366	2.126	0.03570	*
Treatmentenlarged	-0.45838	0.27730	-1.653	0.10113	
Treatmentreduced	0.89784	0.32874	2.731	0.00733	**
WingLength	0.44543	0.03317	13.427	< 2e-16	***

2. Write down the equation of the fitted regression model.

3. What is the average change in weight associated with a 1mm increase in wing length, for sparrows from enlarged nests?

4. What is the estimated difference in weight for sparrows from enlarged vs. control nests, with the same wing length?